



Toyota's sub controversy

After massive blowback from consumers, Toyota reviews new key fob subscription. <https://digit.in/jan22-09>



EV with bat-wing solar panels

A new off-road EV concept boasts bat wing-shaped solar panels, dubbed "Thundertruck". <https://digit.in/jan22-10>

HyperX Cloud Stinger S

A solid pair of mid-range wired gaming headphones

The HyperX Cloud Stinger S is a wired, software-enabled 7.1 surround sound gaming headset and another budget to mid-range offering from HyperX's already versatile lineup of gaming headsets. Priced at ₹5,990, it's got a fair bit of competition from the likes of Logitech and Corsair. So let's take a closer look at these headphones to find out if they're worth picking up.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The HyperX Cloud Stinger S features a design that's very similar to the Cloud Stinger. They've both got an all-black plastic body. You get a microphone that is not detachable and flips upwards.

Coming to the build quality, it's an all-plastic body, as mentioned above, save the metal plate inside the headband. The earcups have faux leather on them, and are pretty comfy, even after long hours of use. There's faux leather on the underside of the headband as well, at the place where it rests on your head. The earcup hinges and the headband itself feel a bit cheap and flimsy when flexed.

We found the Cloud Stinger S to be very comfortable to use. The earcups didn't feel too tight or put a lot of pressure on our ears, and we didn't feel like there was a lot of heat being trapped on our ears. The headphones felt fairly secure on our head, however, tipping your head or intense movement can shake them off pretty easily. Unfortunately, the HyperX Cloud Stinger S is not a good fit for people with smaller heads, who will struggle to get a good seal from these headphones.

At 275g the Cloud Stinger S is also pretty light, which definitely contributes to the overall comfort of the Cloud Stinger S. The earcups on the Cloud Stinger S can swivel, meaning you can



Price
₹5,990

face the earcups down and rest them on your neck when not in use.

FEATURES

The HyperX Cloud Stinger S features 50mm dynamic drivers with a closed-back design. The impedance on these headphones is 32 ohms, which means it should have no trouble being driven by mainstream consoles and should be just about enough to work with smartphones.

These headphones feature onboard volume controls as well, a volume slider that's present behind the right earcup. For the connector, we've got a 3.5mm uni-jack, along with a USB adapter which is required in order to use the 7.1 surround sound.

Coming to the microphone, we've got a polar pattern uni-directional, noise-cancelling microphone. It has the flip-to-mute feature which we love and would love to see all headphones adopt.

PERFORMANCE

The HyperX Cloud Stinger S have a pretty balanced bright-leaning sound profile. This is fairly common in gaming headsets, which basically means that action scenes in games pack a little extra punch. Thanks to its balanced profile, the Cloud Stinger S is also decent for listening to most genres of music. However, these headphones

have no EQ or sound customisation of any kind. Also, sound quality relies quite a bit on the headphones' fit and positioning. The HyperX Cloud Stinger S has average soundstage performance at best, even with 7.1 surround sound turned on. It'll get the job done when playing FPS games, but there are certainly better options out there when it comes to more expansive and accurate soundstage. The Cloud Stinger S also has poor noise isolation, with most outside noise passing through unless you've got the volume turned up high. Which, in turn, leads to leakage.

That finally brings us to the HyperX

Cloud Stinger S's microphone, which we had no complaints about. Voice clarity is great and picks up voice easily.

HyperX's NGENUITY software leaves a lot to be desired. With the HyperX Cloud Stinger S, its sole purpose seems to be turning 7.1 surround sound on and off. That's it.

VERDICT

Priced at ₹5990, the HyperX Cloud Stinger S are a decent pair of mid-range wired gaming headsets. They've got a balanced sound profile that packs a punch to breathe life into action scenes in games. They're comfortable for long periods of use, and work well with all mainstream consoles. The microphone is fantastic, and good for use even in noisy environments. The software is the biggest let down, which offers absolutely nothing in the way of customisation, but at least you're getting 7.1 surround sound at this price range.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVER: 50mm dynamic driver | TYPE: Circumaural, closed back | Frequency response: 18Hz-23kHz | IMPEDANCE: 32 Ω | SOUND PRESSURE LEVEL: 95.5dB SPL/mW at 1kHz | T.H.D.: ≤ 2% | WEIGHT: 275g | CABLE LENGTH: 2.5m | CONNECTION TYPE: 3.5mm plug (4 pole) | MICROPHONE: Electret condenser microphone | POLAR PATTERN: Uni-directional, Noise-cancelling | CABLE LENGTH: 0.15m

CONTACT

HYPERX | PHONE: 1800-258-7160 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://www.hyperxgaming.com/en>